

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7
♥ 10 7 6 4 2
♦ A 6 4 3
♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

1♠

3♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠K

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, West played the ♠7 and North the ♠5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠6, ♠5, ♠4, ♠3 and ♠2. So the ♠7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

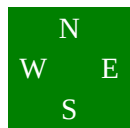
North held up with ♠A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦10 West will win the ♦A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠A while you still have the ♣A for an entry.

Board 2
 East Deals
 N-S Vul

♠ 6 3
 ♥ A J 3
 ♦ K 5 2
 ♣ K Q J 6 2

♠ J 7 5
 ♥ 10 7 6 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7



♠ A 9 8
 ♥ K Q
 ♦ Q J 8
 ♣ 10 9 8 5 3

♠ K Q 10 4 2
 ♥ 9 8 5
 ♦ 10 9 7
 ♣ A 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
3♣	Pass	1♣	1♠
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠K			

falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate East for the fine play.

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, North played the ♠7 and East the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠4.

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that North has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out East's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and North will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if East is a better than average Declarer. North just might hold ♠9 7, giving East ♠A J 8 5. East played the ♠8 as a

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ 6 4
♦ J 7 3
♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ K J 8 3

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 4



♠ K 8 6 3
♥ Q 10
♦ 10 9 5 4 2
♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ A 9 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ 10 9 7

West

North

East

South

2♣

3♣

Pass

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣A

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣4

Play the ♣8 to encourage a continuation. West will
play the ♣Q on which you will play the ♣2.

West now knows you started with a doubleton, and
more importantly, he also knows you want him to
play a third ♣.

When he next plays the ♣K dummy will ruff, but
whatever card he ruffs with you will have established
a trump trick. When you later win your ♠K that will
be down 1.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 5
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ A 10 6
 ♣ Q 10 3

♠ 7 3

♥ J 8 4 3

♦ K J 9 5 2

♣ 8 2



♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K J 9 6 5

♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 10 9

♦ Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♦5			

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, South wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. West holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that South holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If South is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it West's chance of making 9 tricks.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

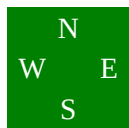
♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

2 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 2

Play the ♣ 3.

If you signal with the ♣ 9 East will continue with the ♣ K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣ J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦ K, return the ♣ 9 back to East's ♣ K, and still have your trump trick for later.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ 10 7 3

♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2



♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

♠ A K Q 10 7

♥ 10 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

1♥

1♠

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♠A

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠A, North plays the ♠9, East the ♠5. You assume North has signaled you to continue ♠s, so you play the ♠Q. On this trick North plays the ♠3 and East the ♠8. How will you continue?

You know that both North and East are now void of ♠s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠Q, North won't bother ruffing, East **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠. North will ruff and East will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of West's ♠J. As you can see, East would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 7

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3
 ♥ Q J 10 7
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5



♠ A 10 5 2
 ♥ 8 5 3
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥Q

he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and South won the ♥A.

South now plays the ♦J on which West plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

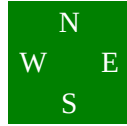
Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦J West played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know

Board 8

West Deals
None Vul

♠ J 10 4
♥ A K 3
♦ J 10 9
♣ A K Q J

♠ A 6 5
♥ Q 10 6 4
♦ K 7 2
♣ 10 5 2



♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 8 7
♦ Q 6 5
♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ 8 7 2
♥ J 9 5 2
♦ A 8 4 3
♣ 8 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥ 4			

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ 4, South plays the ♥ J, won by West with ♥ A.

West plays the ♠ J, you follow with ♠ 5, dummy ♠ 3 and South plays the ♠ 2. West continues with the ♠ 10

Play the ♠ 6.

South's ♠ 2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠ s, obviously 3. Since West also must have 3, you must take your ♠ A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

West may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out West's ♥ K. You will win 2 ♥ s, 2 ♦ s and the ♠ A, down 1

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 7 3 2
 ♥ —
 ♦ 10 9 8 4 3
 ♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q 10 5
 ♥ K Q 9 4
 ♦ K J
 ♣ 8 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 4
 ♥ A 8 7 5 2
 ♦ 7 5 2
 ♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6
 ♥ J 10 6 3
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ Q 10 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥5

plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want East to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 East will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

North is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. East takes the ♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he

Board 10

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 7
♥ Q J 2
♦ Q 10 3
♣ K 10 7 5

♠ 8

♥ A 10 9 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 10 9 4 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A K

♣ Q 8

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 4

♦ J 8 6 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

2 ♥

2 ♠

Pass

All Pass

Pass

4 ♠

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ 4

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ 4, North takes the ♥ A and returns the ♥ 3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥ 3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣ A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 6 3
 ♥ 10 6
 ♦ A K 8 4
 ♣ 8 7 2

♠ K Q 7 5 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 9 6



♠ 10 9 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ A Q J 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 8 7 2

♦ J 10 5

♣ 10 5 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
All Pass			
2 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ A			

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 3

Play the ♦ 2.

You know partner also has the ♦ K, and normally you would give an encouraging signal when you hold the Queen. But with this hand you want partner to switch to ♣s as soon as possible. So you play a low ♦.

West looks at your signal, then looks at dummy, then looks at your signal. He knows you want a switch and it looks like a switch to ♣s might work the best. South plays a low ♣ from dummy, you win the ♣J. Next you play a low ♦, taken by West with his ♦K. West leads a ♣. Dummy plays the ♣K, you win that, cash another ♣, then cash your ♦Q. That first signal led to your side winning the first 6 tricks. Wow.

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 7 5 2

♥ 9 5

♦ K 5

♣ A 10 4

♠ 9 6 4

♥ A K 7 2

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 5



♠ A 10 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K Q J 3 2

♠ 8

♥ Q J 8 4 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ 8 7 6

West

1 ♠

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ A

North

Pass

East

3 ♠

South

Pass

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ A, South puts on the ♥ Q. It's your play.

Play the ♥ 2.

South's ♥ Q is either a singleton, (practically impossible), or a signal showing that he also holds the ♥ J. In either case you can reach the South hand on the second trick by playing a low ♥. Since you don't particularly want to start playing ♦ s from your side, you go ahead and play a small ♥, won by South with the ♥ J.

South next plays the ♦ Q and however West tries it your side will take the next two ♦ tricks and set the contract.

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 9 6 3 2

♥ K 2

♦ Q J 8

♣ 8 7 6

♠ A Q

♥ J 10 4

♦ 10 7 4 3

♣ A K J 2



♠ K 8 7 4

♥ 6 3

♦ A K 9 6

♣ 9 5 3

♠ J 5

♥ A Q 9 8 7 5

♦ 5 2

♣ Q 10 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦ A

before North can pull trumps and discard one of dummy's ♠s on his fourth ♣.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. East led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 2

Play the ♦ Q.

As soon as dummy appears you can see 3 tricks for your side. Partner surely has the ♦ K to go with his Ace and you have a certain trump trick. However, that's all you can see.

Your best hope is that East may be able to win a ♠ trick, and it may be important for the first ♠ lead to come from your side of the table.

Your ♦ Q play informs partner that you also have the ♦ J, giving him the option of underleading his ♦ K to get to your hand.

East next plays a small ♦ which you win with your ♦ J. You return the ♠ 10. This establishes East's ♠ K

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 7		♠ A K Q 3
♥ 5 3 2		♥ K 9 8
♦ 7 3		♦ A J 10
♣ A K J 9 6 4 2		♣ 10 8 5
	♠ 10 8 4	
	♥ J 7 4	
	♦ K Q 8 6	
	♣ Q 7 3	
	♠ J 9 6 5 2	
	♥ A Q 10 6	
	♦ 9 5 4 2	
	♣ —	

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠5

♥J. Hopefully.

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠5, North plays the ♠10 and East wins the ♠K. To the second trick East plays the ♣10 and you must discard something.

Play the ♠J.

You know that North has no high ♠ honor or he would have played it to the first trick. So East has the ♠A Q left, plus all those ♣ tricks. You need to have South switch to a ♥ if possible.

North must be expecting to lead a ♠ back when he wins the ♣Q which you hope he holds. Your ♠J discard may make him rethink. If your ♠s were any good why would you be discarding a winner when all you had to do was toss a small red card?

Hopefully North will come to the conclusion that this is Suit Preference for a ♥ return and will play his

Board 15

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 7 3

♥ 4

♦ 10 6 5 3

♣ 10 7 2

♠ 9 6 2

♥ K 10 6 3

♦ Q 9 4

♣ Q J 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 4

♥ 9

♦ J 8 7 2

♣ A 9 8 6 5 3

♠ J 8 5

♥ A Q J 8 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠ A, dummy played the ♠ 2 and you signal with your ♠ 10. West next plays the ♠ Q and you drop the ♠ 4, completing your doubleton signal. West then plays the ♠ K and it turns out you don't have to ruff after all. So what are you going to play?

Play the ♣ 9.

This should be a clear enough signal for West to play a ♣ to your ♣ A next.

An alternate play, just as good, would be for you to ruff the good ♠ Q and play the ♣ A yourself.

If you don't get your ♣ trick at trick 4 you will never get it. South will discard his ♣ K on North's extra ♦ winner.

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 7 5 4

♥ 10 8 5

♦ A K

♣ 8 5 4

♠ 10

♥ 9 6 4 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ K Q 10 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9 8 6 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ Q 8 4

♣ J

♠ 2

♥ A K J

♦ J 10 6 3 2

♣ A 9 7 2

West

1 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♣K

North

Pass

East

4 ♠

South

You are South. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣K, dummy's singleton was played

Play the ♣9.

North will look at your ♣9 and perhaps think for an instant that you want him to play another ♣.

But it will be a short instant because a look at dummy makes it absolutely clear to everybody that playing another ♣ could not help your side. Dummy has so many trumps that repeated ♣ leads would do nothing.

OK. If it's not an encouraging Attitude signal, what is it? Suit preference of course. Since it is a high spot card you are asking North to switch to the higher suit (choosing between ♦s and ♥s).

North dutifully plays a ♥ and you take the next three tricks. Had he switched to a ♦ instead, West would have been able to discard one of his ♥ losers on East's ♦Q.

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
♥ J 10 6 2
♦ K J 9 5 4 2
♣ 3

♠ K Q J 9 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 6

♣ 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5

♥ 9 7 3

♦ A 8 7

♣ A K 9 8 6 4

♠ A 10 6

♥ A K Q 4

♦ Q 10 3

♣ Q J 2

West

North

East

South

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♣A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A. Seeing your ♣3 he next played the ♦A. What will you play on this trick?

Play the ♦2.

Normally with this holding you would play the ♦9 to encourage East to play a second ♦ through dummy's ♦Q 10.

But this time you really want him to take his ♣K. So play the discouraging ♦2 and hope he gets the message to go back to ♣s. If he does play the ♣K next it will win and he can then give you a ♣ ruff.

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 4 2
 ♥ 9 6 4
 ♦ K Q 8 3
 ♣ K 7 3

♠ J 10 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ A 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K Q

♥ A 10

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8 6 2

♠ 9 8 5

♥ K Q 8 5 3

♦ 9 6 2

♣ J 4

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥5

You are North. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, you put on the ♥J, East won with the ♥A. The second trick was ♦A, ♦2, ♦3, ♦5. The third trick was ♦J, ♦6, ♦8, ♦7. East then put the ♣Q on the table.

Play the ♣A.

Does it look to you like East is trying to create an entry to dummy so he can cash the 2 ♦ winners? That's what he wants it to look like, hoping someone holds up their ♣A.

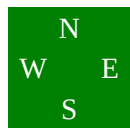
But don't believe Declarer, believe your partner. On the first ♦ South played the ♦2. On the second ♦ he played the ♦6. He has an odd number of ♦s, obviously 3. And East must also have a third one, so he is up to some trickery with that ♣Q.

So grab your ♣A and return partner's ♥ suit.

Board 19
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 5
♥ 9 7 4 2
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 7 6 5 2

♠ K 9 8 6 4
♥ A 6
♦ Q J 3
♣ A K 9



♠ 10 3
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 8 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ J 10 3
♦ A K 10
♣ J 10 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			
Lead: ♠5			

then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

If you had not been paying attention to West's signal you might have decided to risk a ♣ lead - with a disastrous result.

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. The 2♥ bid was a transfer. The 5NT bid meant to choose either 6♠ or 6NT. South liked the suit. Partner led the ♠5, won by South's ♠Q. South pulls one more trump with his ♠A, then wins three high ♦s. Next comes dummy's ♥A on which he plays the ♥3 and West plays the ♥9. Then he leads dummy's ♥6 which you win with the ♥Q. On this trick South drops the ♥J and West the ♥2. It is your play.

Play the ♥K.

If you believe South is now out of ♥s then you should not play your ♥K because it would give him a ruff-sluff.

But you shouldn't believe South when your partner has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that South has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but

Board 20

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 3
 ♥ K Q 7 6 4 3
 ♦ K 10
 ♣ J 9

♠ A Q 10
 ♥ 9 2
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ A K 10 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 4
 ♥ A J 8
 ♦ A Q J 6
 ♣ 8 7 5 4

♠ 9 8 7 5 2
 ♥ 10 5
 ♦ 9 7 4 3
 ♣ Q 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	Pass
1 ♥	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
4 ♥			
All Pass			
4 ♥ by West			
Lead: ♣ A			

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♣ A, South played the ♣ 2 and West the ♣ 9. What should you play to the second trick?

Play the ♣ 6.

On first thought South's ♣ 2 seems to be a discouraging signal. Think again.

After the first trick you know the location of every ♣ except the ♣ Q and ♣ J. If South started with ♣ J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣ J. If South started with ♣ Q J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣ Q. Since he did neither he started either with singleton ♣ 2 or with ♣ Q 2. In either case you should play a low ♣ now which he will either win with his ♣ Q or he will ruff.

It turns out that he wins with the ♣ Q, then leads a ♠ back to your ♠ A Q.